

```
"C:\Users\[your-username]\input.pdf"
```

```
echo Done.
```

```
pause
```

Another common operation is the merger of some PDF files to obtain one single file. In this case, I use the following batch script, in which it's necessary to specify the output file name and the file names of each file to merge them.

```
@rem PDF merge
@rem Input as single files "extract1.pdf extract2.pdf ..."
@echo off
cd C:\gs9.15\bin
gswin32c.exe -sDEVICE=pdfwrite -dPDFSETTINGS=/prepress
-dNOPAUSE -dBATCH -dSAFER -dQUIET ^
-sOutputFile="C:\Users\[your-username]\output.
pdf" ^
"C:\Users\[your-username]\extract1.pdf" ^
"C:\Users\[your-username]\extract2.pdf" ^
"C:\Users\[your-username]\extract3.pdf" ^
"C:\Users\[your-username]\extract4.pdf"
```

```
echo Done.
```

```
pause
```

There is also another operation that's sometimes useful - the conversion from a PostScript file to a PDF file. Even in this case, GhostScript can be the solution. In the following script, it's only necessary to specify the file names of the input and output:

```
@rem PS2PDF
@echo off
cd C:\gs9.15\bin
gswin32c.exe -o "C:\Users\[your-username]\output.pdf" ^
-sDEVICE=pdfwrite -dPDFSETTINGS=/prepress ^
-dHaveTrueTypes=true -dEmbedAllFonts=true
-dSubsetFonts=false ^
-c ".setpdfwrite <</NeverEmbed [ ]>>
setdistillerparams" ^
-f "C:\Users\[your-username]\input.ps"
echo Done.
pause
```

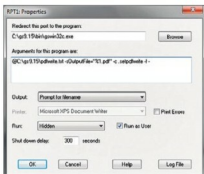


Figure 3: Arguments for GhostScript

GNU Emacs and ImageMagick

There is a lot of software that can be used as a personal finance manager. Some examples are: GnuCash, HomeBank, KMyMoney and Skrooge. I have

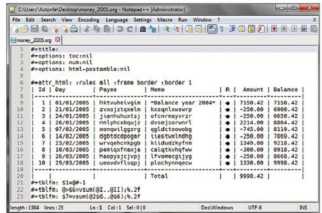


Figure 4: An *org-mode* file opened in Notepad++

tested them on GNU Linux and not on Windows, so I can't say more about their installation and use on Windows. This kind of program is nice but I'm not satisfied with it.

Another option is to use something like Ledger (<http://www.ledger-cli.org>), which is available for Windows too. But I prefer to follow a personal method and use *org-mode* to build some tables. With these tables, I can't do queries and reports, but I don't need them. A typical table I use has seven columns:

1. ID, which is a progressive integer
2. Day, which is the date when the operation is done
3. Payee, which is the payee
4. Memo, which is the explanation of that operation
5. R, which is used to show if the operation has been reconciled or not
6. Amount, which is the amount in that operation that can be a positive or a negative number
7. Balance, which is the running total

The first row is the total balance for the previous year. At the end of the table, there are the following three rows:

```
#+tblfm: $1=@-#1
#+tblfm: @:$6=vsum@I..@I1;%2f
#+tblfm: $7=vsum@2$6..@$6;%2f
```

The first adds the ID number (column 1), the second calculates the total balance value (the sum of all the values in column 6) and the third calculates the running total (column 7). This is a simple, practical and very fast way to open a file on a text editor and to print as *html*, when necessary. Figure 4 shows an *org-mode* file opened in Notepad++ with the free and open source font Hack v2.010 (<http://sourcefoundry.org/hack>). Regarding ImageMagick - after the installation, to verify if it's working properly, type each of the following lines at the command prompt:

```
convert logo: logo.gif
identify logo.gif
display logo.gif
```